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Computer Engineering

Company: Oracle Financial Services Software

Job Profile: Associate Consultant

Offer Type: Placement

Internship Stipend: N/A

CTC: 9.82 LPA

Location: Mumbai / Pune / Bengaluru / Chennai

Process Date: Sept 15, 2025 – Oct 8, 2025

Placement Process:

1. Open Assessment (Sept 15, 2025)
2. Technical Interview – 1 (Oct 8, 2025)
3. Technical Interview – 2 (Oct 8, 2025)
4. HR Interview (Oct 8, 2025)

Note: The OA was common for both the Associate Consultant and Application Developer roles. Although I was not shortlisted for the Application Dev role after the assessment, I was later shortlisted for the Associate Consultant role based on the same OA performance.

1. **Open Assessment** [Eligibility criteria: 7 CGPA, with no current backlogs]

The OA was conducted on HackerRank, consisted of questions from the following:

- Data Structures & Algorithms (2 questions, everyone had different questions):
 1. Based on Arrays - Easy difficulty
 2. Based on Trees - Moderate difficulty
- Computer Science Fundamentals:
 1. Computer Networks
 2. Operating Systems
 3. SQL (Joins, Aggregate functions, constraints)
- Aptitude & Reasoning:
 1. Logical reasoning and probability based quantitative aptitude
 2. Analytical puzzles

2. **Technical Interview - 1** [27 students were shortlisted for this round]

The interview began with a brief self-introduction. I kept my response concise, summarizing what I have learned over the course of my studies, and highlighting my interest in Machine Learning. I also mentioned that Python is my primary programming language, while I'm comfortable with Java and SQL as well. I concluded with a short note on my long-term goals and hobbies.

The interviewer then moved on to discuss my projects. She began with my major project. I explained the idea behind it and what my specific contributions were. Next, she asked me about another project, which was an open-access platform for managing and exploring research papers. I described its main features and briefly outlined my role in developing its core functionalities.

After that, she reviewed the technical skills listed on my resume and asked several follow-up questions. When asked about my preferred programming language, I mentioned Python. She then asked why not Java, to which I explained that Python's simplicity, extensive libraries, and faster prototyping capabilities make it ideal for research or machine learning related tasks, which align more closely with my interests. When asked why many companies still prefer Java, I replied that Java offers better performance in large-scale enterprise systems, strong type safety, and a good support for multithreading and scalability.

She later asked some questions related to database design, including schemas and access controls along with some SQL functions. She then asked about the use of JavaScript - I explained that it is primarily used for adding interactivity to web pages and is essential for front-end development, especially when working with frameworks like React

She noticed I had mentioned Android SDK in my resume and asked whether I had built any Android apps. I mentioned that I had developed one as a mini-project during my second year in Java (though not listed in my resume) and asked me several related questions.

We also discussed the scalability differences between SQL and NoSQL databases, after which she moved on to Git and version control systems. I explained concepts like repositories, commits, branching, merging, and pull requests, and described how multiple developers collaborate using Git. I also shared a basic diagram to illustrate the workflow and mentioned common Git commands used for these operations.

The interviewer then moved to Data Structures, asking how linked lists work and their real-life applications. I answered honestly when I could not recall specific applications. I was then asked to write a function to calculate the first n Fibonacci numbers, which I implemented.

Next, she asked a few Linux command questions, which were fairly straightforward. She then asked about Tableau since I had listed it under my skills. When asked why Tableau and not Power BI, I responded that Tableau provides a more intuitive interface, faster data blending, and better integration with Python for analytics, making it a preferred choice for exploratory data analysis.

Finally, she asked a few questions about my certifications, which I had completed. When I was asked why I didn't have any formal internship experience, I explained that I didn't find opportunities that aligned with my interests at the time. Instead, I focused on personal and academic projects, which helped me apply my learning effectively.

3. **Technical Interview - 2** [~20 students were shortlisted for this round]

This interview skipped the introductory “Tell me about yourself” and started directly with my projects. He began with my major project, asking me to explain it in detail again, and then moved on to some other project. He probed further into how I managed certain functionalities, how I implemented specific features, and posed hypothetical scenarios such as “If you were to implement X, how would you do it?”. He also inquired whether the project was hosted, to which I replied, it was not, and asked a few other technical details. Overall, the focus was on being thorough and precise about my projects.

The discussion then shifted to SQL, where I was asked to write a query involving aggregate functions and GROUP BY. He also asked several Python-related questions, including the use of inbuilt functions, and explored my understanding of the language in detail.

He further revisited my technical skills listed on the resume, asking clarifying and in-depth questions. While he maintained a serious and formal demeanor, I remained calm and answered to the best of my ability.

Note: Both of these interviews lasted for around **45-50 minutes** and were manageable as long as you remain calm, honest, and well-versed with every little detail mentioned in your resume, as the interviewer may ask in-depth questions based on your listed skills, projects, and certifications. I have attempted to include all the questions I was asked, although I may have missed a few, this experience reflects the overall structure and focus of the interviews.

4. **HR Interview** [12 students were shortlisted for this round]

The HR interview was short, lasting around 5 minutes. It started with some basic questions, first confirming my nationality, followed by queries about the role being offered and the compensation details. She then asked if I would be comfortable relocating to any of the mentioned work locations, to which I replied yes.

Next, she inquired if I was planning to pursue higher studies, to which I replied no. When asked why, I mentioned that I didn’t have any such plans in the near future, but might consider it a few years down the line if I ever decide to. The conversation then moved to whether I had any current offers or PPOs from other companies; I said no, and when asked if I had appeared for other interviews, I told her this was my first interview ever.

Overall, the round was relaxed and conversational, and all candidates who reached this stage were offered the position.

Personal Insights:

I was rejected in most of my earlier open assessments, and even when I cleared some, I was eliminated during group discussion rounds. I had been studying on and off for placements since they began in the month of July and by the end of September, I was honestly burnt out, mainly because I wasn’t seeing any results despite putting in consistent effort and not getting shortlisted for interviews. Still, I kept reminding myself to stay patient and keep improving, and finally received this offer in the second week of October,

after nearly three months. I also started my placement preparation quite late compared to many peers (which in hindsight was a bad idea), but this made me realize that placement success isn't just about hard work, there's also a fair bit of timing and luck involved. What matters is staying consistent, realistic, and open to learning. Even if things don't work out right away, every attempt adds experience and clarity, and eventually, your effort finds its result.

Lastly, I had a CGPA of 7.66, which made me eligible for almost all companies, except maybe one (Zeta which had a requirement of 8+). Based on my experience, it's recommended to maintain at least a 7.5 CGPA, as that tends to be the minimum eligibility criterion for most companies during campus placements.

Areas of Improvement:

Looking back at the entire placement process, there are a few areas I believe I could have improved on:

1. Early and consistent preparation: I started my placement preparation quite late, which added unnecessary pressure toward the end
2. Confidence and composure: Showing structured thinking and confidence in your answers makes a big difference in how the interviewer perceives you, even if you don't get every answer right. It's important to remember that interviewers generally want you to succeed and are looking for how you approach problems, not just whether you know the exact answer.

Overall, this experience helped me identify where I stood technically and learned a lot about what to focus on moving forward.